Research Methodology & IPR

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Lecture Number 04 (December 01, 2025, at 2:30 PM)

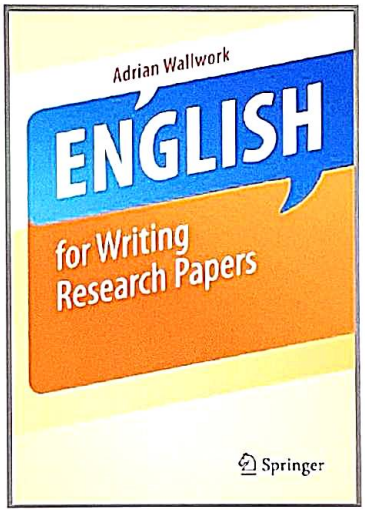
Writing $\xleftrightarrow{\text{Copying others' research}}$ Plagiarism

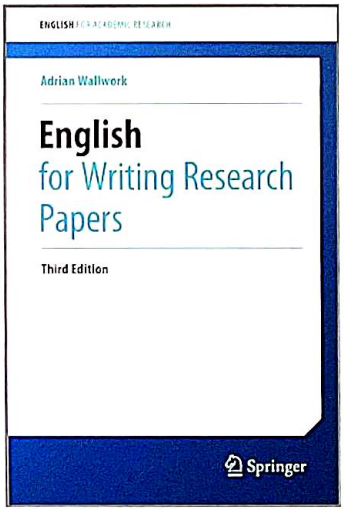
A Course for M.Tech. in Biomedical Instrumentation, Computer Science & Engineering, and Optics & Optoelectronics

University of Calcutta, July - December 2025 Semester

1. Plagiarism
2. Avoid
3. Quotation
4. Paraphrase
5. Refer Names
6. CrossCheck
7. Questions?

Reference book





What is plagiarism

- Plagiarism means cutting and pasting from other studies and papers.
  means taking credit for work that others have done
- Plagiarism includes plagiarizing your own work
  some journals don't allow more than five words/sentences from your past paper!
- If a reviewer comments that a paper is plagiarised, it is rejected!
  plagiarism can reject a paper, or even blacklist an author!
- Plagiarism can impact negatively for the university/institute
  Plagiarism also is a negative name for the country of origin
- Authors must understand "what is and what is not plagiarism, and how to paraphrase other people's work without plagiarism." How to avoid plagiarism?

How to spot and avoid plagiarism

- If there are many wrongly constructed English sentences, and there is one single well-written sentence, it is likely that it is a copy paste sentence.

  searching the Internet may give the original source

- Thus, it is advisable not to copy others' English sentences verbatim. Read the original paper and write the content in your own words without looking at the original paper.

  Read and write whatever you remember, but NEVER copy verbatim

- Learning English construction of phrases is perfectly fine, but it should be generic, not copied verbatim in specific topic. Learning English paraphrasing and picking writing style are accepted.

How to directly quote from others' research works

- Quote the exact phrases with quotation marks, and refer the paper in a citation.

  insert verbatim texts within quotation marks and cite the paper

- Putting quotation marks may imply that you haven't understood it!

  some reviewers may imply it. So, it is better to write it in your language and refer a citation

- Although using quotation marks to quote exact phrases doesn't technically constitute plagiarism, some plagiarism checker software may mark it as plagiarism!

  So, it is better to write it in your language and refer a citation

How to paraphrase to quote others' research works

- Paraphrase others' sentence(s) using your own words. MUST refer others' papers in citations
- If you don't refer it in citations, it would appear that those are your own words!
  referencing citations is a MUST whatever you quote by paraphrasing
- It is important that you understand the work you are using in your writing.
  Don't write that you haven't clearly understood

Refer names of the author(s) while paraphrasing others' research

- Write names of the author(s) in your paraphrased texts.

  Should mention names of author(s) whose works you paraphrase

- Put the reference(s) in the paraphrased texts of others' research.

  Should mention citation(s) of author(s) whose works you paraphrase

- You may avoid names by using a phrase like "Another author reported" or similar with a citation. Mentioning other author(s)' names is a better way

Cross check if you inadvertently committed plagiarism

- Check if your journal offers CrossCheck (a service by www.crossref.org)

  it checks your paper against thousands of others if the same phrase appears in someone else's work